had the opportunity to get to know each other previously, when I was the head of a department in the Mossad and he was defense minister.

As the Mossad director is directly subordinate to the prime minister, the nature of my relationship with Rabin when he was defense minister was not hierarchical. I would present him with joint IDF and Mossad operations and hold debriefs with him from time to time. When Rabin was appointed prime minister, I had been serving as director of the Mossad for three and a half years, so the work relations, trust, and mutual esteem, as well as the personal relations that made me and my wife Yael regular guests in Yitzhak and Leah's home, developed very quickly. The fact that he had supported another candidate to be Mossad chief never even came up between us.

"Silence is praise to you," it says in Psalm 65 about God. Rashi, the great Jewish commentator, explains that since there is no limit to the glory of God, there are no words that can describe it. Therefore, the best way to describe his glory is silence. Similarly, it seems that when you try to describe the personality and virtues of Prime Minister Yitzhak Rabin, you cannot find the right words, and silence is what best describes what you are trying to say.

When I found myself among those standing helplessly outside of the operating room in the basement of Ichilov Hospital, waiting for Prof. Gabi Barabash's report while the doctors tried desperately to resuscitate the prime minister, time seemed to stand still. The situation was like a time tunnel, with your stream of consciousness working overtime and questions arising in your mind about eternity—the eternity of man, the eternity of the nation, the eternity of the divine spirit.

In the Judaism of "free will," "permission to kill" exists only among fundamentalists, who dare to pose as God Almighty himself. The only thing from which there is no way back is death, and therefore on issues relating to the Land of Israel it is inconceivable that the authority to permit the killing of a Jew would lie in the hands of man. The sentence of the degenerate who cut short the life of the prime minister is infinitely more in the realm of the true divine spirit.

Yitzhak's roots, which connected him to the Jewish people and the Land of Israel, were as deep and entrenched as the history of this people. The perpetuity of the people and the land was the number one concept that guided him, above and beyond any political or public debate. He did not mention these issues very often, but there was a rare event at which I heard